BEER LEAGUE HOCKEY ASSOCIATION

OWNER WELCOME PACKET

Everything a founding owner needs: how the league works, where the money goes, your first week and where to find it all in Discord.

SEASON 2027–28 · 12 FRANCHISES · EST. 2026



BLHA

BEER LEAGUE HOCKEY ASSOCIATION

EST. 2026

FROM THE COMMISSIONER

WELCOME TO THE BLHA

You're one of twelve founding owners in a dynasty league built to last: a Startup Draft in 2027, an inaugural season in 2027-28, and a record book that starts with your name in it.

The BLHA runs on two things. Fantrax is where the hockey happens: rosters, lineups, scoring, trades and standings. Discord is the league office and the clubhouse: news, rulings, votes, trade talk and a fair amount of chirping. The Constitution sits over both, and it's short enough to read in one sitting. Please do.

This packet is the quick version. It covers how the league works, where the money goes, what to do in your first week and where everything lives in the server. When this packet and the Constitution disagree, the Constitution wins.

Build something you're proud of. Trade often. Set your lineup. Welcome to the league.

The Commissioner

IN THIS PACKET

The league at a glance 03
Playing the season 04
Scoring and the money 05
Your first week 06
The Discord map 07
Traditions and help 08

AT A GLANCE

12	$200	22
FRANCHISES	DUES A SEASON	WEEKS · H2H POINTS
6	**$1,000**	**36**
PLAYOFF TEAMS	FAAB A SEASON	ROSTER SPOTS + 5 IR

FORMAT

Head-to-Head Points with daily lineups. A 22-week regular season where every franchise plays every other franchise twice. No divisions, no conferences.

Weeks run Monday to Sunday, and every league time is Eastern Time.

THE ROSTER

Active	20
3 C · 3 LW · 3 RW · 3 F · 6 D · 2 G. The F slot takes any forward.	
Reserve	6
Minors	10
Injured reserve	up to 5
Controlled spots, not counting IR	36

An illegal roster has to be fixed within 24 hours of notice ⟨6.4⟩.

MINORS

- Age 23 or younger on the first day of the NHL regular season, as Fantrax calculates it. A birthday during the season doesn't change it.
- Skaters qualify through 100 career NHL regular-season games. Goalies qualify through 30.
- When Fantrax flags a minor as ineligible, you have 3 days to promote, trade or drop him.
- Promotion doesn't burn eligibility. A player who still qualifies can go back down.

LINEUPS

Set your lineup every day. Each player locks about one minute before his NHL game. Keep it legal and reasonably competitive all season ⟨9.1⟩.

THE CONSTITUTION CONTROLS

This packet is the short version. When the two disagree, the Constitution wins ⟨2.6⟩. Read it in 📜 constitution.

PLAYING THE SEASON

WAIVERS AND FAAB

- $1,000 FAAB each season. It doesn't roll over.
- Hidden bids in $1 steps, and $0 bids are allowed. A tie goes to the earliest bid.
- Claims process daily around 11:00 AM ET. There are no first-come, first-served adds.
- Up to 8 acquisitions per Week. Trades, draft picks and drops don't count.

GOALIE STARTS

A maximum of 4 goalie starts count each Week, and 8 across the two-week Championship. The live scoreboard shows how many each team has used. Using a timing quirk to get credit past the maximum isn't allowed (9.4).

TRADES

- Unlimited, with no league vote and no veto.
- Trade players, picks in the next three Annual Drafts (all five rounds) and current-season FAAB.
- No conditional picks, cash, loans, rentals or side deals.
- Deadline: Sunday 11:59 PM ET at the end of Week 20. Trading reopens the day after the Stanley Cup Final.
- Report a misclick or platform error within 48 hours.

PLAYOFFS

- Six franchises make it. Seeds 1 and 2 get byes.
- Quarterfinals are 3 vs. 6 and 4 vs. 5, and the bracket reseeds after each round.
- Quarterfinals and Semifinals last one Week each. The Championship is a two-week cumulative matchup.
- The Semifinal losers play for third place during the Championship.
- The other six play a consolation bracket. Its champion gets a $50 FAAB bonus next season.
- An exact tie goes to the higher seed.

STANDINGS TIEBREAKERS

Points scored, then head-to-head among the tied teams, then Fantrax's next tiebreaker, then a random draw.

ANNUAL DRAFT ORDER

1.01 to 1.06 go to the six non-playoff teams, lowest Potential Points First: what your best possible lineup would have scored. Benching your stars won't move you up.

1.07–1.08 Quarterfinal losers · 1.09 fourth · 1.10 third · 1.11 runner-up · 1.12 champion. Five rounds, same order every round.

SCORING AND THE MONEY

SKATERS

Goal	+3.00
Assist	+2.97
Shot on goal	+0.33
Block	+0.44
Hit	+0.14
Penalty minute	-0.36

GOALIES

Game started	+3.00
Save	+0.36
Goal against	-3.00
Goal	+3.00
Assist	+2.97

Not scored: wins, shutouts, plus/minus, power-play bonuses, game-winning goals and faceoffs.

WHERE THE $2,400 GOES

BLHA Champion	$880
Runner-Up	$480
Third Place	$200
Presidents' Trophy	$280
Dynasty Pot	$380
Operating Reserve	$200
League Services	$100
12 Franchises × $200	$2,400

The Operating Reserve pays for Fantrax Premium and other approved costs, and whatever is left stays in the reserve for future costs. League Services is the Commissioner's allocation for running the league (3.6).

DUES

$200 per franchise, due before each season's draft, paid through Fantrax Treasurer. A payment counts once the Commissioner confirms it in the League Ledger. Prizes are paid within 30 days after the Championship, with a Season Ledger in 💰 | league-ledger.

THE DYNASTY POT

The first franchise to win three BLHA Championships in the same cycle takes the whole pot. They don't have to be in a row. It grows by at least $200 every season, then resets once it's won.

PAY FIRST, THEN TRADE

To trade away a future 1st- or 2nd-round pick, your dues must be paid and confirmed through that pick's season first, or the whole trade is reversed (Article XII). Picks in rounds 3 to 8 need no prepayment.

SCORING IN ACTION

+15.76
A BIG NIGHT
2 goals, 1 assist, 8 shots and a hit

+3.05
THE GRINDER
3 shots, 4 blocks, 3 hits, 2 PIM

+11.80
A SOLID START
30 saves, 2 goals against

-14.36
A ROUGH NIGHT
19 saves, 6 goals against

YOUR FIRST WEEK

- [ ] **Accept your Fantrax invite** and claim your Franchise.
- [ ] **Start in** 👋 | welcome and pick your notification roles under Channels & Roles.
- [ ] **Read the Constitution** in 📜 | constitution. Joining the league means accepting it.
- [ ] **Pay your $200 dues** through Fantrax Treasurer before the deadline on 📅 | league-calendar.
- [ ] **Name your Franchise:** a city and a team name, a short abbreviation and your colors. It goes up in 🏒 | franchise-directory.
- [ ] **Turn on Fantrax app notifications** for trades, claims and lineup problems.
- [ ] **Opt in to Lineup Alerts.** Ask the Commissioner, and 🔔 | lineup-alerts will tell you when a starter has no game but a reserve does.
- [ ] **Watch your inbox** for Last Call, the league's weekly email.
- [ ] **Say hello** in 💬 | gm-lounge.
- [ ] **Build your draft queue** before the Startup Draft.

DRAFT DAY

The Startup Draft cheat sheet has the draft rules, the scoring math and a board to fill in as you pick. Keep it next to you when the clock starts.

KEY DATES

[DATE]
Dues deadline
At least 30 days' notice, and before the Startup Draft.

[DATE]
Startup Draft
14 to 21 days after the NHL Entry Draft ends.

[DATE]
Roster compliance
Announced before the draft.

[DATE]
Week 1
With the NHL's opening night.

[DATE]
Trade deadline
Sunday 11:59 PM ET, end of Week 20.

[DATE]
Regular season ends
Sunday 11:59 PM ET, end of Week 22.

[DATE]
Playoffs
Four Weeks: Quarterfinals, Semifinals and a two-week Championship.

[DATE]
Trading reopens
The day after the Stanley Cup Final.

Every date is posted on 📅 | league-calendar.

THE DISCORD MAP

Discord is the league office and the clubhouse. Automated rooms post on their own; conversation happens in the rooms built for it.

🏛️ LEAGUE OFFICE

- 👋 | **welcome** Start here
- 📜 | **constitution** The rules, always current
- 📢 | **announcements** Official notices
- 📅 | **league-calendar** Every date and deadline
- 💰 | **league-ledger** Dues, prizes and the Dynasty Pot
- 🗳️ | **league-voting** Formal Franchise votes
- 🏆 | **hall-of-champions** Every champion and award
- 📚 | **league-records** League history and milestones

📰 THE WIRE

- 🚨 | **breaking-news** News that changes a decision now
- 📰 | **nhl-news** The daily NHL feed
- 🏥 | **injury-report** Injury updates
- 🔄 | **nhl-transactions** Real NHL roster moves
- 🌱 | **prospect-wire** Prospect news
- 💬 | **news-desk** Talk about the news

💼 GENERAL MANAGERS

- 💬 | **gm-lounge** The clubhouse
- 🏒 | **game-day** Live games, goalies, Pick'em
- 😂 | **chirps-and-memes** Friendly trash talk
- 🍺 | **off-topic** Everything else
- 📸 | **media** Clips, photos and graphics

🔄 TRADE CENTER

- 📣 | **trade-block** What you'll move
- 🎯 | **looking-to-acquire** What you're hunting for
- 💬 | **trade-discussion** Ideas and valuations
- 🚨 | **completed-trades** The record of every trade
- 📈 | **player-values** Dynasty values and rankings

🌱 SCOUTING DEPARTMENT

- 🔎 | **scouting** Every prospect, one Forum

💰 WAIVER WIRE

- 💵 | **waiver-talk** FAAB strategy and pickups
- 👀 | **waiver-watch** Who to watch before claims run

🏆 LEAGUE COMPETITION

- 📊 | **scoreboard** Live scores for the Week
- 📈 | **standings** After every Week
- 📰 | **weekly-recap** Results and awards
- 🏁 | **playoff-race** Who's in, who's on the bubble
- 🏆 | **playoffs** Matchups and results
- 🥄 | **consolation-bracket** The other six
- 🔔 | **lineup-alerts** Daily heads-up ⟨opt in⟩

🧑‍⚖️ COMMISSIONER'S OFFICE

- 🎫 | **commissioner-support** Private help from the Commissioner
- ❓ | **rules-questions** Ask how a rule works
- 💡 | **league-suggestions** Ideas, start to finish
- 🎟️ | **open-a-ticket** Private tickets and appeals
- ⚖️ | **rulings-log** Official rulings
- 📖 | **owner-handbook** The week-to-week basics

🎯 DRAFT CENTER

- 📢 | **draft-announcements** Official draft notices
- 🎙️ | **draft-room** Live draft talk
- 🔄 | **draft-day-trades** Trades during the draft
- 📋 | **draft-results** The pick-by-pick board

🏒 FRANCHISE HQ

- 🏒 | **franchise-directory** Every Franchise and owner
- 📰 | **franchise-news** News from each Franchise
- 📋 | **roster-showcase** Show off your team

The Commissioner's Office also has private staff rooms, and owners can only react in automated rooms like 🔔 | lineup-alerts.

TRADITIONS AND HELP

TRADITIONS AND SIDE GAMES

Awards Night. After the Championship, owners vote 5-3-1 for GM of the Year, Trade of the Year, Waiver Steal of the Year, Comeback Franchise and Bust of the Year.

Monthly Awards. Manager of the Month, Best Record, Biggest Single Week and Hard Luck, in 📰 | weekly-recap.

Bounties. One-time season goals. The first franchise to reach one takes the Bounty Hunter role.

Pick'em. Pick each Week's winners in 🏒 | game-day. A season leaderboard keeps score.

BLHA Bucks. A play-money sportsbook on BLHA matchups. The season's top earner is the Sharp.

NHL Playoff Pool. A free box pool once the fantasy season ends. The winner is the Pool Shark.

The Wooden Spoon (proposed). Last place holds the Spoon for the offseason and writes the next season's preview. Owners decide whether it happens.

All of it is for bragging rights: no money, no picks, no FAAB.

GETTING HELP

A rules question? Ask in ❓ | rules-questions. Binding answers are posted in ⚖️ | rulings-log.

Something private? Open a ticket in 🎟️ | open-a-ticket.

Disagree with a ruling? An affected franchise can open an Appeal ticket within 48 hours. Three owners from unaffected franchises, drawn at random, decide by majority (19.4).

An idea for the league? Post it in 💡 | league-suggestions. Rule changes are voted on in the offseason and need 8 of the 12 franchise votes.

The week-to-week basics live in 📖 | owner-handbook.

Once the League Bot is live, /myteam, /rule, /deadlines, /minor and /tradecheck answer right in Discord.

SEE YOU AT THE DRAFT

Beer League Hockey Association · Est. 2026. Questions before then? Open a ticket any time.